



Man of peace?

Ending the Vietnam War was a highlight of Kissinger's career, and one for which he was jointly awarded the Nobel Peace Prize with Le Duc Tho, North Vietnam's chief negotiator. Duc declined the prize on the grounds that real peace had not been achieved.

From Germany to Harvard

Born in 1923—the first of two sons—to orthodox Jewish parents in Fürth, Germany, Kissinger began life as Heinz Alfred. The family moved to England in 1938 to escape Nazi persecution, and then to the United States, where Heinz became Henry. The young Kissinger attended City College of New York before being drafted in 1943. His native